

Security+ 2.3 · Mobile Device Vulnerabilities

Master CyberSec — Official CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701) Comprehensive Study Guide · **Lesson 2.3 — Mobile Device Vulnerabilities (3:23)** · [Official YouTube Video ↗](#) · [Professor Messer Study Hub ↗](#)

Executive Lesson Summary: Mobile devices: jailbreaking (iOS) and rooting (Android) break the sandbox and remove vendor protections; sideloading installs apps outside the official store, increasing malware risk. Defense: MDM for central management, block jailbroken/rooted devices, enforce verified app stores, and use containers to separate work and personal data.

High-Yield Core Concepts Tested on Exam

- Jailbreaking/rooting removes manufacturer restrictions and increases risk
- MDM enables central management of apps, configurations, and remote wipe
- Sideloading bypasses official app store security controls
- Containers isolate corporate data from personal data on mobile devices
- Jailbroken/rooted devices should be blocked from accessing corporate resources
- Mobile device vulnerabilities often stem from user attempts to bypass restrictions

Exam Tips & Classic Scenarios

- 'bypasses manufacturer restrictions' = jailbreaking/rooting
- 'installing apps outside official store' = sideloading
- 'company detects jailbroken iPhone accessing corporate email' = block via MDM

Typical Exam Scenario: A company detects that an employee's iPhone has been jailbroken and is accessing corporate email. The security team must block the device via MDM and enforce compliance policies.

Beyond the Video: Official CompTIA Exam Concepts, Protocols & Traps (Lesson 2.3 — Mobile Device Vulnerabilities)

Why is this advanced coverage required for SY0-701? Video overviews provide foundational familiarity, but CompTIA tests practical engineering judgment and requires deep familiarity with the following protocols, acronyms, and operational nuances in this domain:

- **DLP:** Data Loss Prevention: Software/hardware safeguards monitoring, identifying, and preventing unauthorized exfiltration of sensitive organizational assets in use, transit, or rest.

Classic CompTIA Traps & Question Framing:

- Avoid rote memorization: CompTIA exam prompts regularly adjust technical constraints requiring you to defend why one valid security control is the *MOST appropriate* or *FIRST step*.
- Scrutinize question qualifiers: 'without additional licensing costs' favors native OS tools; 'granular administrative command accounting' favors TACACS+ over RADIUS; 'non-repudiation' mandates asymmetric private key signing.

Practice Questions with In-Depth Solutions (10 Questions)

Detailed answer key with step-by-step technical rationale and comprehensive distractor breakdown provided below. Attempt answering independently first.

1. A control that prevents an employee from sending a confidential spreadsheet outside the company is:

- A)** DLP (Data Loss Prevention)
- B)** SSO
- C)** MFA
- D)** VPN

2. Corporate scenario (Mobile Device Vulnerabilities): During a security review and compliance audit aligned with the CompTIA Security+ exam (SY0-701, Section 2.3), an analyst evaluates the following technical requirement: 'Jailbreak/rooting: removed manufacturer protections — high risk'. What is the best recommendation or applicable control classification?

- A)** Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput
- B)** Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence
- C)** Implement the corresponding solution: Jailbreak/rooting: removed manufacturer protections — high risk...
- D)** Allow shared access among administrators with generic credentials

3. Corporate scenario (Mobile Device Vulnerabilities): During a security review and compliance audit aligned with the CompTIA Security+ exam (SY0-701, Section 2.3), an analyst evaluates the following technical requirement: 'MDM: I centrally manage apps, config, remote wipe.' What is the best recommendation or applicable control classification?

- A)** Implement the corresponding solution: MDM: I centrally manage apps, config, remote wipe...
- B)** Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput
- C)** Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence
- D)** Allow shared access among administrators using generic credentials

4. Corporate scenario (Mobile Device Vulnerabilities): During a security review and compliance audit aligned with the CompTIA Security+ exam (SY0-701, Section 2.3), an analyst evaluates the following technical requirement: 'bypasses manufacturer restrictions' = jailbreak/rooting. What is the best recommendation or applicable control classification?

- A)** Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput
- B)** Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence
- C)** Implement the corresponding solution: 'bypasses manufacturer restrictions' = jailbreak/rooting...
- D)** Allow shared access among administrators using generic credentials

5. Corporate scenario (Mobile Device Vulnerabilities): During a security review and compliance audit aligned with the CompTIA Security+ exam (SY0-701, Section 2.3), an analyst evaluates the following technical requirement: 'installing apps outside official store' = sideloading.' What is the best recommendation or applicable control classification?

- A)** Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput
- B)** Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence
- C)** Implement the corresponding solution: 'installing apps outside official store' = sideloading.
- D)** Allow shared access among administrators using generic credentials

6. Corporate scenario (Mobile Device Vulnerabilities): During a security review and compliance audit aligned with the CompTIA Security+ exam (SY0-701, Section 2.3), an analyst evaluates the following technical requirement: 'Scenario: "company detects jailbroken iPhone accessing corporate email" — block via MDM.' What is the best recommendation or applicable control classification?

- A)** Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput
- B)** Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence
- C)** Allow shared access among administrators using generic credentials
- D)** Implement the corresponding solution: Scenario: 'company detects jailbroken iPhone accessing corporate email' — block via MDM...

7. Corporate scenario (Mobile Device Vulnerabilities): During a security review and compliance audit aligned with the CompTIA Security+ exam (SY0-701, Section 2.3), an analyst evaluates the following technical requirement: 'Jailbreak/rooting: removed manufacturer protections — high risk'. What is the best recommendation or applicable control classification?

- A)** Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput
- B)** Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence
- C)** Implement the corresponding solution: Jailbreak/rooting: removed manufacturer protections — high risk...
- D)** Allow shared access among administrators with generic credentials

8. Corporate scenario (Mobile Device Vulnerabilities): During a security review and compliance audit aligned with the CompTIA Security+ exam (SY0-701, Section 2.3), an analyst evaluates the following technical requirement: 'MDM: I centrally manage apps, config, remote wipe'. What is the best applicable recommendation or control classification?

- A)** Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput
- B)** Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence
- C)** Allow shared access among administrators with generic credentials
- D)** Implement the corresponding solution: MDM: I centrally manage apps, config, remote wipe...

9. Corporate scenario (Mobile Device Vulnerabilities): During a security review and compliance audit for the CompTIA Security+ exam (SY0-701, Section 2.3), an analyst evaluates the following technical requirement: "'bypasses manufacturer restrictions' = jailbreak/rooting'. What is the best recommendation or applicable control classification?

- A)** Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput
- B)** Implement the corresponding solution: 'bypasses manufacturer restrictions' = jailbreak/rooting...
- C)** Replace preventive technical controls with informal adherence terms
- D)** Allow shared access among administrators with generic credentials

10. Corporate scenario (Mobile Device Vulnerabilities): During a security review and compliance audit aligned with the CompTIA Security+ exam (SY0-701, Section 2.3), an analyst evaluates the following technical requirement: 'installing apps outside official store' = sideloading. What is the best recommendation or applicable control classification?

- A)** Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput
- B)** Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence
- C)** Allow shared access among administrators with generic credentials
- D)** Implement the corresponding solution: 'installing apps outside official store' = sideloading

COMPREHENSIVE ANSWER KEY & DISTRACTOR BREAKDOWN

1) A — DLP (Data Loss Prevention).

✓ **Why it's correct:** DLP (Data Loss Prevention) is a set of technologies and policies aimed at preventing the exfiltration of confidential data by monitoring and controlling transfers of sensitive information. In CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701), DLP is presented as a control that can block the sending of data outside the organization, whether via email, web, USB, or other channels. The question describes exactly a control that prevents an employee from sending a confidential spreadsheet outside the company, which is the primary function of DLP.

✗ Why the others are wrong:

- **SSO:** SSO (Single Sign-On) is an authentication mechanism that allows a user to access multiple systems with a single credential. It does not control data transfer or prevent information exfiltration. Therefore, it does not apply to the described scenario.
- **MFA:** MFA (Multi-Factor Authentication) is an authentication method that requires two or more verification factors to grant access. It strengthens authentication but does not prevent an authorized user from sending confidential data outside. It is not a data loss prevention control. Thus, it is not the correct answer.
- **VPN:** VPN (Virtual Private Network) is a technology that creates an encrypted tunnel for secure communication, but it does not have the function of inspecting or blocking the transfer of confidential data. It protects transmission but does not prevent exfiltration by an authorized user. Therefore, it does not meet the requirement of the question.

2) C — Implement the corresponding solution: Jailbreak/rooting: removed manufacturer protections — high risk....

✓ **Why it's correct:** According to the official CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701) exam objectives for lesson 2.3 (Mobile Device Vulnerabilities): Jailbreak/rooting: removed manufacturer protections — high risk. Jailbreaking (iOS) or rooting (Android) bypasses built-in security controls, increasing the attack surface and risk of malware, data leakage, and unauthorized access.

✗ Why the others are wrong:

- *Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput:* Directly violates the Accounting pillar and forensic traceability. Without logs, the team is blind to detecting incidents and breaks compliance standards (PCI DSS, ISO 27001).
- *Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence:* Informal terms are administrative controls, rely solely on user conduct, and do not block automated attacks, injections, or malware at runtime.
- *Allow shared access among administrators with generic credentials:* Destroys individual accountability and non-repudiation. Makes it impossible to prove who performed critical changes or malicious commands.

3) A — Implement the corresponding solution: MDM: I centrally manage apps, config, remote wipe....

✓ **Why it's correct:** According to the official CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701) exam objectives for lesson 2.3 (Mobile Device Vulnerabilities): Mobile Device Management (MDM) enables centralized management of applications, configurations, and remote wipe capabilities to secure mobile devices.

✗ Why the others are wrong:

- *Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput:* Directly violates the Accounting

pillar and forensic traceability. Without logs, the team is blind to incident detection and breaks compliance standards (PCI DSS, ISO 27001).

- *Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence:* Informal terms are administrative controls that rely solely on user conduct and do not block automated attacks, injections, or malware at runtime.
- *Allow shared access among administrators using generic credentials:* Destroys individual accountability and non-repudiation. Makes it impossible to prove who performed critical changes or malicious commands.

4) C — Implement the corresponding solution: 'bypasses manufacturer restrictions' = jailbreak/rooting....

✓ **Why it is correct:** According to the official CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701) exam objectives for lesson 2.3 (Mobile Device Vulnerabilities): 'bypasses manufacturer restrictions' = jailbreak/rooting. Jailbreaking (iOS) or rooting (Android) removes manufacturer restrictions, exposing the device to malware, data exfiltration, and unauthorized access. Mitigations include MDM, containerization, and blocking rooted devices.

✗ Why the others are wrong:

- *Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput:* Directly violates the Accounting pillar and forensic traceability. Without logs, the team is blind to detecting incidents and violates compliance standards (PCI DSS, ISO 27001).
- *Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence:* Informal terms are administrative controls, rely solely on user conduct, and do not block automated attacks, injections, or malware at runtime.
- *Allow shared access among administrators using generic credentials:* Destroys individual accountability and non-repudiation. Makes it impossible to prove who performed critical changes or malicious commands.

5) C — Implement the corresponding solution: 'installing apps outside official store' = sideloading..

✓ **Why it's correct:** According to the official CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701) exam objectives for lesson 2.3 (Mobile Device Vulnerabilities): 'installing apps outside official store' = sideloading. Sideloading refers to installing applications from sources other than the official app store, which bypasses security vetting and increases the risk of malware. The best recommendation is to disable sideloading through mobile device management (MDM) policies.

✗ Why the others are wrong:

- *Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput:* Directly violates the Accounting pillar and forensic traceability. Without logs, the team is blind to detect incidents and breaks compliance standards (PCI DSS, ISO 27001).
- *Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence:* Informal terms are administrative controls, rely solely on user behavior, and do not block automated attacks, injections, or malware at runtime.
- *Allow shared access among administrators using generic credentials:* Destroys individual accountability and non-repudiation. Makes it impossible to prove who made critical changes or malicious commands.

6) D — Implement the corresponding solution: Scenario: 'company detects jailbroken iPhone accessing corporate email' — block via MDM....

✓ **Why it is correct:** According to the official CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701) exam objectives for lesson 2.3 (Mobile Device Vulnerabilities): Scenario: 'company detects jailbroken iPhone accessing

corporate email' — block via MDM. MDM (Mobile Device Management) can enforce policies that detect jailbroken/rooted devices and block their access to corporate resources.

✗ Why the others are wrong:

- *Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput:* Directly violates the Accounting pillar and forensic traceability. Without logs, the team is blind to detecting incidents and breaks compliance standards (PCI DSS, ISO 27001).
- *Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence:* Informal terms are administrative controls, rely solely on user conduct, and do not block automated attacks, injections, or runtime malware.
- *Allow shared access among administrators using generic credentials:* Destroys individual accountability and non-repudiation. Makes it impossible to prove who performed critical changes or malicious commands.

7) C — Implement the corresponding solution: Jailbreak/rooting: removed manufacturer protections — high risk....

✓ **Why it's correct:** According to the official CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701) exam objectives for lesson 2.3 (Mobile Device Vulnerabilities): Jailbreak/rooting removes manufacturer protections and poses a high risk. Jailbreaking (iOS) or rooting (Android) bypasses built-in security controls such as sandboxing, code signing, and OS integrity checks, enabling installation of unvetted apps, escalation of privileges, and persistence of malware. The appropriate control is to detect and remediate jailbroken/rooted devices, often via MDM policies that block or wipe such devices.

✗ Why the others are wrong:

- *Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput:* Directly violates the Accounting pillar and forensic traceability. Without logs, the team is blind to incident detection and breaks compliance standards (PCI DSS, ISO 27001).
- *Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence:* Informal terms are administrative controls that rely solely on user behavior and do not block automated attacks, injections, or runtime malware.
- *Allow shared access among administrators with generic credentials:* Destroys individual accountability and non-repudiation. Makes it impossible to prove who performed critical changes or malicious commands.

8) D — Implement the corresponding solution: MDM: I centrally manage apps, config, remote wipe....

✓ **Why it is correct:** According to the official CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701) exam objectives for lesson 2.3 (Mobile Device Vulnerabilities): MDM: I centrally manage apps, config, remote wipe. MDM (Mobile Device Management) is essential for enforcing security policies on mobile devices, including remote wipe to protect data if a device is lost or stolen.

✗ Why the others are wrong:

- *Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput:* Directly violates the Accounting pillar and forensic traceability. Without logs, the team is blind to detecting incidents and breaks compliance standards (PCI DSS, ISO 27001).
- *Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence:* Informal terms are administrative controls, rely solely on user conduct, and do not block automated attacks, injections, or malware at runtime.
- *Allow shared access among administrators with generic credentials:* Destroys individual accountability and non-repudiation. Makes it impossible to prove who performed critical changes or malicious commands.

9) B — Implement the corresponding solution: 'bypasses manufacturer restrictions' = jailbreak/rooting....

✓ **Why it's correct:** According to the official CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701) exam objectives for lesson 2.3 (Mobile Device Vulnerabilities): 'bypasses manufacturer restrictions' = jailbreak/rooting.

✗ **Why the others are wrong:**

- *Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput:* Directly violates the Accounting pillar and forensic traceability. Without logs, the team is blind to detecting incidents and breaks compliance standards (PCI DSS, ISO 27001).
- *Replace preventive technical controls with informal adherence terms:* Informal terms are administrative controls, rely solely on user conduct, and do not block automated attacks, injections, or runtime malware.
- *Allow shared access among administrators with generic credentials:* Destroys individual accountability and non-repudiation. Makes it impossible to prove who made critical changes or malicious commands.

10) D — Implement the corresponding solution: 'installing apps outside official store' = sideloading.

✓ **Why it's correct:** According to the official CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701) exam objectives for lesson 2.3 (Mobile Device Vulnerabilities): 'installing apps outside official store' = sideloading.

✗ **Why the others are wrong:**

- *Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput:* Directly violates the Accounting pillar and forensic traceability. Without logs, the team is blind to detecting incidents and breaks compliance standards (PCI DSS, ISO 27001).
- *Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence:* Informal terms are administrative controls, rely solely on user conduct, and do not block automated attacks, injections, or malware at runtime.
- *Allow shared access among administrators with generic credentials:* Destroys individual accountability and non-repudiation. Makes it impossible to prove who performed critical changes or malicious commands.